Ethics Statement

The program has one clear ethical upside and a few risks that ABC should talk about before it goes live.

The upside is fairness. Everyone punches in and out the same way, and every work event is saved with a start and end time. Nobody's hours depend on a supervisor's memory or a messy time card, and each worker can check their own record in the Jobs Completed Report.

The biggest risk is access control. The program identifies people by employee number only, and employee numbers are not secret. Anyone who knows a coworker's number can open that person's report and see exactly when they worked. They can also punch someone else in or out, which breaks the fairness the system is supposed to give. A PIN or badge scan would fix both problems, so we should ask ABC whether they want one.

The 5:30 PM auto punch-out can also hurt workers. If someone stays until 6:30 to finish a rush job, the system closes their record at 5:30 without telling them, and that last hour is never recorded or paid. ABC should decide how late work gets logged, for example by showing a warning or letting a supervisor fix the record.

Finally, the person who used to track hours by hand may lose that work. ABC has a responsibility to move them to another role or retrain them, not just let them go.